51 to 55) complete this group. The fourth and longest episode (bars 55 to 68) separates this from the coda; it begins with a free transposition of episode 1 to the fifth below, with a new continuation from bar 62, still built on the semiquaver bass. The coda contains four partial entries of the subject, in bars 68, 72, 76 and 79; a fourth voice is added from bar 80.

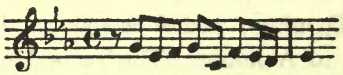
Great unity of character is given to this fugue by the derivation of nearly the entire material from the subject itself.

FUGUE 26 (Book II, 2)

C MINOR (FOUR VOICES).

An exceptionally fine fugue. An unusual feature is that, though it is in four parts, the fourth voice does not enter until bar 19. But it is most noteworthy for its two splendid stretti.

Exposition.—The subject—



commencing on the dominant, takes a **tonal** answer. The alto leads, the treble follows; and the tenor, giving the subject in bars 4, 5, completes the exposition.

Counter-Exposition.—To this succeeds, after two bars of episode, a regular counter-exposition, though again only in three parts, and with a redundant entry in the tenor at bar 11, transiently in F minor. The answer in the tenor (bar 7) and the alto (bar 10) substitutes the major third of the dominant for the minor, and the subject in the treble (bar 8) slightly varies the

Ebenezer Prout: Analysis of J. S. Bach's Forty-Eight Fugues
Ed. Louis B. Prout. London: Edwin Ashdown, 1910. Printed pp. 54-55.
BWV 871. Complete original pages; adjoining commentary is retained.
Full source scan

rhythm. A codetta leads to a cadence in G minor, closing the first section of the fugue.

Middle and Final Sections.—These are not clearly differentiated, as there is scarcely any modulation away from the two principal keys. It would be possible to regard either the first entry of the bass (bar 19) or the beginning of the second stretto (bar 23) as marking the commencement of a "final section"; but the latter is more in the character of a coda.

The first stretto commences at bar 14, the subject in the treble being immediately imitated in the alto by augmentation, and in the next bar answered by inverse movement in the tenor. From the 16th bar the subject and answer appear at distances of half a bar in the three upper parts, and at bar 19 the fourth voice (the bass) makes its appearance with fine effect, giving the subject by augmentation. The inverted and the original forms of the answer follow immediately in the same voice, bars 21 to 23. In bar 23 begins the second, and closer stretto. Here the alto and treble take the subject and answer at one crotchet's distance, and again—reversing their order of entry—successive appearances of the subject, commencing respectively on tonic and dominant; two beats later the tenor introduces the subject, and two beats later again the bass brings it in, inverted and somewhat modified.

The entire fugue is one of the most perfect in the series.

FUGUE 27 (Book II, 3)

C SHARP MAJOR (THREE VOICES).

A very troublesome fugue to analyse, owing to the difficulty in determining where the subject terminates. An examination of